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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

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Most households are headed informally by the eldest member. In one of the camps at Doringbos (No. 1 of the list in Table 6) the household elder occupies a status not unlike that of traditional headmen. He is frequently consulted to mediate in or settle disputes, not only within his own household and cluster but also, occasionally, in other households in the mission village. He is an old farm Bushman who is acclaimed for his good judgement and wide experience. He is a good dancer and considered by the Bushmen as an expert on the "old ways." Gaishe also knows the Africans. He is fluent in Tswana (he is the churchinterpreter) and has lived together with Africans for many years. He is also the only San in the area who was ever married to an African woman. He also speaks some Afrikaans and is familiar with European ways, as he has worked on their farms all his life. Many of the D'Kar farmers know "ou Gaishe" (old Gaishe) and hold him in esteem.

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Here it is appropriate briefly to mention the kinship system of the Nharo farm Bushmen.⁵ It has stabilizing effects on social interaction and contributes to the general sense of communitas that characterizes most farm bushman villages. The eleven basic kin terms are shown in Figure 4. In addition, there are three broad relationships that cut across or modify the 11 specific relations. These are an avoidance relationship (dau'i); a relation of closeness, affection and mutual help (tssxō)—as well as of obscene joking and teasing—and [p. 81]

Fig. 4—Chart of basic kin relations of Nharo-Tssau San

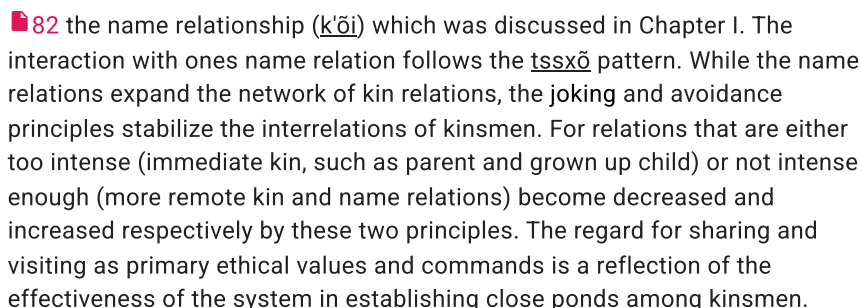
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⁵For an extended description of the Ghanzi Nharo kinship system see Barnard, 1975, 1978.

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